

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, August 27, 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau - absent
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept the minutes of the July 23, 2025, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

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Mayor Girard apologized for the delayed start of the meeting.

The Council is planning on hosting a special meeting next Tuesday evening to potentially give tax revenues to the School District early, and invoices for field use and the School Resource Officer. The Council wants to be completely transparent and do what is best for the taxpayers of Claremont.

On September 2nd from 7am to 7:30pm the Supervisors of the Checklist will have a session for voter registration.

On September 3rd there will be a School Board meeting at 6:30pm.

City elections will be held on November 4th. The filing period will be Wednesday September 17th through Friday September 26th. The City Clerk's Office will be open on Friday September 26 from 3p-5p.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Manager Bates reported Washington Street will work on their final line painting tonight, and smoothing transitions tomorrow.

Core samples have been done throughout the project. There is consistent 2 inches of pavement on the road, Manager Bates noted Pike has extended a thank you and appreciation to all of the City staff for their time being on-site. Manager Bates thanked the staff for a great job and the residents for bringing concerns to the City Manager's Office and the Department of Public Works so that issues can be addressed. A final walk and drive inspection will be done within the next few days, and Pike will begin the rail trail portion of the project after Labor Day.

North and Main Upgrades had unanticipated delays due to ledge, old piping that needs to be replaced and several other issues. Manager Bates apologized to the public for the inconvenience and appreciates everyone's patience.

17 Water Street purchase and sale agreement will be discussed tonight.

There have been delays with the final approved budget books but should have these items in an upcoming meeting.

The FY24 audit is coming soon, and scheduled to start FY25 in hopes to be completed by March before the budget.

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The tax collector will be presenting a final tax deeded property list at the second meeting of September.

Councilor Koloski would like a status of selling water to pool companies.

Councilor Hemingway questioned why a portion of Main Street is blocked off on one side.

Director Gleeson noted he will look at the detour signs but thinks its for the re-routing of truck traffic.

Mayor Girard noted back in May the Council voted on a Charter Change for the residency requirement and questioned if this has been received by the state.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen's forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you'd like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

Elizabeth Cram, Ward I, asked if there was a time and place for the Council Meeting proposed on Tuesday. Mayor Girard stated it will be noticed.

Norm Blouin, Ward III, shared concerns for safety involving ambulances, materials and road conditions of East Green Mountain Road, and the spending of money in the City.

Hope Damon, State Representative for District 8 wanted to follow up on the supervisors of the checklist session and stated there are some changes needed for documentation such as: Proof of identity, Proof of citizenship, and Proof of NH Residency, documentation should be brought if there has been a name change, and noted it was important to vote.

Ms. Damon also commented on the fiscal crisis in the Claremont school system, and has been asked why the state hasn't stepped in and noted there is no statute for the state of New Hampshire to do so.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 640 Merit System Amendment to Attachment B Payroll and Human Resources Specialist [Part Time] – Second Reading

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Human Resource Director, Shannon Thibodeau explained the internal restructuring by creating two dedicated roles, one to be more involved in finance and one for Human Resources.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Koloski to pass Ordinance 640 to a third and final reading at the September 10th, City Council Meeting.

Councilor Hayden read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

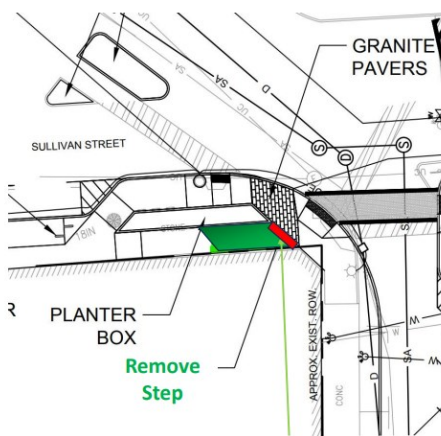
Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Sullivan Street Sidewalk Options Discussion

Director Gleeson and Manager Bates presented visual options for discussion on Sullivan Street.

IDEA # 1



Grade sidewalk to slope
as a ramp vs. the current step



Remove Step & Create Incline to Meet
ADA Compliance and Allow for Easier
Maintenance

IDEA #2



Design with pattern on pre-cast concrete/brick but with larger sidewalk
On the top of retaining wall with rail on top.

Councilor Greenrose's initial thought is not liking option #2 with a concern about the crosswalk.

Director Gleeson clarified the crosswalk is just there for visual, but it would mirror other side.

Councilor Koloski mentioned a majority of the Council at the last meeting didn't want a railing, and the other concern is the City has already spent money on this project, and thinks that option #1 seems the most economical.

Councilor Hayden likes option #1, and added how planter boxes have been a hot topic so planter boxes should be a future agenda item.

Manager Bates pointed out on option #1 the planter box that is there now will need to be taken out and reconfigured, rounded out on edges, and is trying to work out a long term plan for the planters downtown for several reasons.

Councilor Heminway preferred the look of option #2. However, feels option #1 is best and cheapest.

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
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Councilor Limoges is not a fan of the flower boxes but agrees option #1 would be best. Mayor Girard noted the consensus of the Council is to move forward with option #1.

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2026-14 Fund Transfer for M&W Soils Engineering, Inc – Public Hearing

Manager Bates stated this was brought up at the last meeting and was directed to come back with a resolution. Test pits will be done Friday morning, and once the report comes back the City can then move forward with a structural engineer.

RESOLUTION 2026-14

USE OF FUND BALANCE – VISITOR CENTER ENGINEERING STUDY

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

WHEREAS, the City has concerns about the stability of the slope and soil supporting the Visitor Center at 14 North Street, and has determined a need to have a geotechnical engineer perform a foundation and site investigation at said location; and

WHEREAS, there was no appropriation in the FY26 General Fund Budget for such an expense;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, to raise and appropriate a sum not to exceed \$16,000.00 from the General Fund Balance to perform a foundation and site investigation at 14 North Street Visitor Center (with no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be necessary to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 27th day of August 2025, in the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept Resolution 2026-14.

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
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Councilor Koloski read Resolution 2026-14 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Authorization of Easement for Eversource Structure Replacements (City Manager/Project Manager)

Manager Bates clarified this is an easement for improvements not an easement for a right of way.

Joseph Hoebeke, Connor Jennings, and Daniel Turaj from Eversource presented their project for the improvements to the road access of the K174 transmission lines to ultimately upgrade the wooden structures with steel.

The Council’s main concern is for the conservation efforts of that area, and inquired if Conservation Commission Chair, Gary Dickerman, was made aware of this project.

Gary Dickerman, Ward III, Chair of the Conservation Commission, noted he had a meeting with Manager Bates to discuss this topic and invited Eversource to the next Conservation Commission meeting.

Motion to Authorize Easements For Eversource Utility Pole and Line Work

The Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or her designees to negotiate, execute and take all such actions as may be required to convey Eversource Energy utility easements related to upgrading Cat Hole Road and placement of temporary matting to support access to the Eversource Right of Way to perform necessary power line upgrades. Any easement

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
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granted is explicitly for Eversource's K174 ACR Project and expires at the conclusion of this project, not to extend beyond October 31, 2026, unless a written extension from the City of Claremont is granted. Said easement to be detailed in an appropriate Easement Agreement to be filed in the Sullivan County Registry of Deeds at Eversource's expense.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to authorize the Easement for Eversource.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2026-16 Purchase and Sale Agreement – 17 Water Street – Public Hearing

Manager Bates presented the Purchase and Sale Agreement for 17 Water Street.

Matt Bacon, on behalf of 1852 noted the excitement to embark on their second project of the City, And thanked the Council.

RESOLUTION 2025~~6~~-16

AUTHORIZATION TO SELL MUNICIPAL PROPERTY – 17 WATER STREET

WHEREAS the City of Claremont purchased property known as 17 Water Street, Map 120 Lot 8, from the State of New Hampshire on March 10, 2025 ; and

WHEREAS the City of Claremont purchased said property with the primary intention of controlling the development of said property; and

WHEREAS after receiving and reviewing proposals through a public RFP process;

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED after public hearing duly noticed, that the Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the sale of municipal property known as 17 Water Street, Map 120 Lot 8, to 1852 MB CLAREMONT, LLC, a New Hampshire limited liability company for consideration of \$1,015,000.00; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the proceeds of the sale, less any closing costs, shall first be applied to the outstanding loan and interest on said property, then to offset carrying costs since the time of purchase, with the residual going to General Fund Balance; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or her designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be necessary to implement this resolution. (*2/3 Vote Required*)

Dated this 27th day of August 2025 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

AYES _____

ABSENT _____

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Koloski to accept Resolution 2026-16

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Clerk to Council Ms. Bizzarro mentioned the Council needs to make an amendment for the Resolution number from 2025-16 to 2026-16. Councilor Hemingway and Councilor Koloski accepted this change.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Water Street, United Way, Crescent Street Parking Plan Discussion

Councilor Koloski stated due to being a key holder for one of the properties in this area he is recusing himself for the conversation.

Director Bates started the discussion and read the memo.

Memorandum

To: Honorable Mayor and Council Members
From: Nancy Bates, Acting City Manager
Date: 2025-08-27
Re: Parking and Lot Lines on Water Street/Crescent Street/United Way

With the recent purchase by the City of two parking lots, one on Water Street and one on United Way/Crescent Street, and the impending sale of 17 Water Street by the City, it seems a good time to take a big picture look at City-owned property and parking spaces in that area to ensure the best distribution, utilization, and winter maintenance.

17 Water Street has 2 handicap and 7 regular parking spaces on the parcel. The developer is proposing a maximum of 30 units. In its conversations with the developer, the City Council committed to maintaining the availability of parking spaces in the recently acquired Lot B and Lot C on the drawing. There is a steep grade transition with stairs between the upper and lower parts of Lot C on the drawing.

I propose exploring the possibility of redistributing parking and adjusting lot lines in the areas of Lots B through H, excluding E, which is City-owned but has deeded parking spaces to Lot F. In addition, I would like to suggest adjusting the lot line behind 45 Crescent Street to eliminate a minimally used, non-compliant sidewalk and provide that lot with better rear access to the building (this area has little to no public benefit).

I believe this overall area can be reconfigured to maximize parking, create better lot lines, and eliminate several areas from the City's maintenance list.

If the Council is interested in pursuing this idea, I would like permission to approach the leasees and potentially affected property owners on behalf of the City to collaborate on a plan for consideration by Council at a future meeting.

Councilor Greenrose noted a constituent reached out and asked if this is a matter of moving or shuffling spaces or will there be any construction.

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Manager Bates explained there were no plans for construction at this time, and no intention of ripping anything up. This is to clean up and do deed research into clarifying lot lines along with reconfiguring some of the City lot lines.

Based on consensus council gives permission to Manager Bates to move forward with the research of lot lines and approach lot owners and leasees.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Koloski noted the committee is scheduled to be on the September 24th agenda to present the inventory, and the board is in the process of creating post cards for raising funds.

Councilor Greenrose noted the Historic District Commission approved 5 projects one of them including Matt Bacon's project on 32-40 Pleasant Street. The Energy Committee now has minutes and wanted to bring to public attention that there are a number of tax credits for residents expiring at the end of this year.

Councilor Koloski reported the Planning Board had an application for a substantial sized housing project on Central Street and a conceptual for a lot merger and then noted concerns for how presented site plans are recorded.

Councilor Hayden reported the conservation commission is pursuing a discussion with Upper Valley Land Trust for Cat Hole easement, and Claremont Savings Bank offered storage for tools.

Councilor O'Hearne reported the Tolles Home is hiring a subcontractor for bookkeeping and is now working on the site manager.

Mayor Girard reported the Airport had a special meeting and stated there was discussion on a solar project, and after initial conversation the advisory board didn't feel like they had enough information. The board felt it was best to move on from this project at the moment.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Zutter asked about education for ballot charter amendments.

Councilor Koloski would like the fee schedule to come back to Council.

Councilor Koloski had concerns about a duplicate City of Claremont website with former Council members and old info.

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Councilor Koloski would like permission to arrange recognition for boards and commission members.

By Consensus Council agrees Councilor Koloski can move forward with arranging recognition to boards and committees.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:32 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor Zutter and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council